

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Acer TabletPC

Take a tablet

The TravelMate C100 weighs just 1.4 Kg and measures 9.9 x 8.2 x 1.16-inches. A single hinge binds the screen to the keyboard. The four-way scroll key, located at the base of the touchpad, makes scrolling through long documents and Web pages convenient. The touchpad is responsive and the small keyboard is designed for easy text input.

To switch to Tablet PC mode, you have to push open the latches located at the side of the screen, swivel the screen clockwise, and fold it back on top of the keyboard. The screen orientation has to be changed to portrait using either the pre-assigned hardware button or the Tablet and Pen settings icon. The device comes with two electronic pens—a PDA-sized stylus that is housed in the edge of the screen bezel, and a regular-size pen. Both pens have side buttons that allow you to right-click while tapping. The regular pen also has an eraser in the form of a second electronic sensor on the top of the pen.



Based on the Windows XP Tablet PC edition, the C100 is easy to carry around and work on in the Tablet PC mode. You can use the onscreen virtual keyboard or input panel to write text. The handwriting recognition feature converts this accurately into editable text that can be inserted into any application.

The two SmartCards provided in the kit are used with the PlatinumSecret software suit to provide authorised access and enhanced data security.

This candidate for the future of mobile computing is powered by its aplenty features.

SPECIFICATIONS

800 MHz mobile Intel Pentium III processor, 256 MB SDRAM, 10.4-inch TFT LCD display, 30 GB hard drive, two USB ports, Ethernet (RJ-45), modem (RJ-11), IEEE 1394 (Firewire), Infrared, optional 802.11b wireless LAN, five launch keys, four-way scroll key, built-in microphone and speakers, SmartCard slot, Type II PCMCIA slot

Price: Rs 1,59,990
Contact: Acer India Pvt Ltd
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Acer TravelMate C100 B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Olympus C-5050Zoom

In your eyes

The Olympus C-5050 ZOOM has a black, rugged body made of magnesium alloy. This makes it slightly heavy, which adds to the feel of a professional camera.

When set to Control Panel mode you get information about the camera status on the LCD screen. You can focus by viewing the movable LCD screen or using the optical viewfinder.

The camera allows Smart Media, xD-Picture Cards, as well as Compact Flash cards for storing pictures. Two memory slots—one accepting either, Type I or II Compact Flash cards, including the IBM Microdrive; the other accepts either SmartMedia or a xD-Picture Card. We tested the camera with the 32 MB xD-Picture Card that came bundled.

The quality of the photographs is very good. The picture quality highlights shadows and brightness very well, and details are picked up with great accuracy. In order to test the resolution, water droplets on a leaf were photographed. The results were excellent, with even the reflections of the environment visible on the droplets of water. The zoom is quite powerful with-

out pixelation and the shutter speed, aperture size, white balance and flash type can be controlled using a button and the jog wheel.



The photographs are transferred to a computer via the high speed USB port. At a tag of Rs 49,995, the camera is reasonably priced, and is ideal for budding photographers.

SPECIFICATIONS

113.5 x 79.5 x 69.5 mm, 5 megapixel, 375 g without battery, 4 AA or 2 CR-V3 batteries, DC in, maximum resolution 2560 x 1920, Optical viewfinder, Auto Focus, image ratio 4:3 or 3:2, 1/1.8 inch CCD sensor, 1.8 inch TFT colour LCD display, Digital ESP metering, spot metering, shutter speed from 4 seconds to 1/1000 seconds, aperture F1.8 to F8.0, self timer mode, 3x optical zoom, (focal length from 35 mm to 105 mm) supports RAW, JPEG and TIFF picture formats

Price: Rs 49,995
Contact: Komal International
Phone: 022-22631366
Fax: 022-22610219
E-mail: indiaolympus@vsnl.com
Web site: www.olympus.com

Olympus C-5050Zoom A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶